Active Support Core Extensions

Active Support is the Ruby on Rails component responsible for providing Ruby language extensions, utilities, and other transversal stuff.

It offers a richer bottom-line at the language level, targeted both at the development of Rails applications, and at the development of Ruby on Rails itself.

1 How to Load Core Extensions

1.1 Stand-Alone Active Support

In order to have a near-zero default footprint, Active Support does not load anything by default. It is broken in small pieces so that you can load just what you need, and also has some convenience entry points to load related extensions in one shot, even everything.

Thus, after a simple require like:

```
require 'active_support'
```

objects do not even respond to `blank?`. Let's see how to load its definition.

1.1.1 Cherry-picking a Definition

The most lightweight way to get `blank?` is to cherry-pick the file that defines it.

For every single method defined as a core extension this guide has a note that says where such a method is defined. In the case of `blank?` the note reads:

Defined in `active_support/core_ext/object/blank.rb`.

That means that you can require it like this:

```
require 'active_support'
require 'active_support/core_ext/object/blank'
```

Active Support has been carefully revised so that cherry-picking a file loads only strictly needed dependencies, if any.

1.1.2 Loading Grouped Core Extensions

The next level is to simply load all extensions to `Object`. As a rule of thumb, extensions to `SomeClass`are available in one shot by loading `active_support/core_ext/some_class`.

Thus, to load all extensions to `Object` (including `blank?`):

```
require 'active_support'
require 'active_support/core_ext/object'
```

1.1.3 Loading All Core Extensions

You may prefer just to load all core extensions, there is a file for that: